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SHORTCHANGING PAKISTAN

I'M VERY clear about the principle of self-confidence. If you don't have self-confidence, a core belief in yourself, you don't have anything. It is in this area that I think the Pakistan cricket team, thanks to the Pakistan Cricket Board, has lost the self-belief it once had. It's unfortunate, but I'm forced to make such an assessment because of the facts.

Firstly, I don't think the PCB has anyone – not one qualified man or woman – who can stand up to or debate or argue confidently with the highest levels of the ICC, the governing body of global cricket. That's because the PCB doesn't have confidence, nor does it have a plan. And because it doesn't have a plan, it doesn't have any ambitious objective or long term-goal for Pakistan cricket.

The problem of the PCB is not uncommon in Pakistan. There aren't enough professionals within the organization. Instead, there are shortsighted bureaucrats who just want to save their own seats and skins. It's not like they don't work. Of course they do, but they don't do – can't do – anything grand or fantastic because they can't think beyond tomorrow or the day after tomorrow.

If the PCB adopts a long-term approach to the game, say for the next five to 10 years, then Pakistan cricket would be on a different trajectory of growth and development, and the nature of cricket in Pakistan would be different too. Sadly, the board thinks on a tournament-to-tournament basis and on sponsor-to-sponsor terms. It's sad because, as it limits itself, it limits the game and stifles the achievements that men – like my teammates and myself – can bring home.

I hate recommending this but maybe if a couple of foreign professionals came in to manage the PCB as an aggressive, forward-looking business unit and took up the CEO (chief executive officer) or the COO (chief operating officer) role, or any position that is empowered, then Pakistan cricket would start to look and feel different. Other multinational companies in different sectors expand their horizons and operate similarly in Pakistan. Why can't the PCB do the same with its international outreach and, perhaps, Pakistan's most globally known product and brand